

Tailor file size to your requirements

temporary files from your hard disk after the conversion is done. Now select the 'Maximum CD size' you would like. The default value is 635 MB. Leave it at this value if you are using a 650-MB CD. Else change it to the required value.

EasyDivX does the conversion in a series of steps. Let's take a look at them, one step at a time.



The default option is 'Auto Select Movie'. Leave this option on until you're familiar with the fine art of ripping. This option selects all the VOB files you need to rip onto the hard disk. You can close PowerDVD once you see the .vob files under 'Available Files'.

Select the VOB files you want to convert if you're using the 'Manually Select VOBs' option. If you are not sure about which VOB files to convert, select all of them. Use the 'Select Files From Hard Disk' option if you have VOB files already on your hard disk.

Click on 'Next Step' once you are through with the selection.



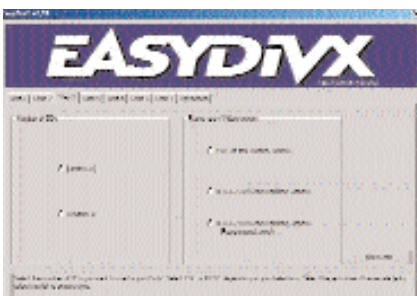
Enter the length of the movie in minutes in the text box. You can get the movie length from the DVD pouch. Select

the type of sound format you want from Stereo and AC3. Select the AC3 option only if you have a multichannel soundcard or if you are burning two CDs. Click on 'Next Step'.



Here, select the number of CDs you want the DivX file to come in. If you want to compress the file in a single CD, leave the 'Single CD' option on. This will be of lower quality because of the smaller file size.

If you want to play the output of your DivX movie on a TV, change the 'Frame rate' or 'Video system' option to PAL. This is the video system we use in India. If you will be playing it only on your PC, leave the default option (NTSC 29,976) on.



Specify how many CDs the file should take



Specify the Aspect ratio as 4:3 if you want the output display to be the same as that of your DVD. Set the Codec option to DivX 4 2-pass for the best quality. Keep in mind that this will take longer than the other two Codec options. (On our test bench it took nearly 2 hours 30 minutes to encode using the DivX 4 Codec at constant bitrate option.)



## Watch out for...

Do not convert unless the DVD belongs to you and make only one back up for personal use. You break copyright laws if you lend, rent out or sell your backup to someone else.

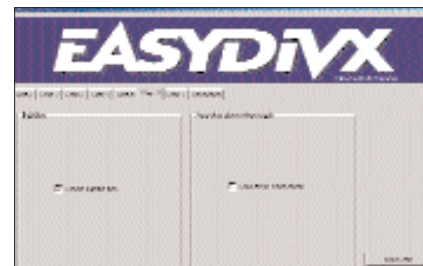
You CANNOT use DVDs that are not of your region. India's region code is 05. If your DVD's case has a code other than India's, do not use or convert it. If your DVD does not have a region code on it, it can be played in any country.



Set the Primary language as English.



Select the 'Create subtitle files' if you want to see subtitles in your movie.



Your DivX copy can even have the subtitles



Select the directory where you want to save the output DivX movie. Click on the 'Go for it' button and the process starts. The whole process will take more than 2 hours at the least. Our machine took about 5 hours and 24 minutes to convert a 112-minute DVD. The time taken will depend on the quality you are encoding at (the default is 342x240 pixels at 523 Kb bitrate) and the machine you are using. If you are converting a DVD of around 8 GB, it is always better that you have spare space of at least 10 GB on the particular partition that you are storing the conversion output in.

Now go to the folder you specified for the output, click on the file, and Windows Media Player will play the file for you. Voila! Your own DivX backup is ready for your viewing pleasure. Store it in your hard disk or burn it onto a CD for safe storage.

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## DVD Conversion Essentials

The term ripping is used while converting DVDs to other formats. It is important to understand that ripping is just one part of the conversion process. The other important steps involved are encoding of audio/video and multiplexing.

DVDs consist of VOB and IFO/BUP files. VOB video files consist of video and audio streams combined (multiplexed) together. IFO files have information about how the DVD has to be played. BUP files are backup files for the IFO files in case they get corrupted. It is important that you include IFO/BUP files during ripping, otherwise the ripped files will play incorrectly.

Now comes the (g)ripping part! DVD files are encrypted using a method called CSS (Content Scrambling System) encryption. CSS allows you to copy DVD files onto your hard disk, but you won't be able to play them. Ripping lets you get around this encryption and copy the files onto your hard disk. The copied files will be in a format that can be played by software DVD players. The video files are then encoded by EasyDivX. The next step is to decode and encode the audio files into stereo/AC3 format as you have specified. The last step is to multiplex the video and audio files.